

Board 1

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 5 4 2

♥ 7 3

♦ A 8 4

♣ Q J 9 6

♠ Q 10 6

♥ K 8

♦ K Q 6 5

♣ 8 7 5 3



♠ A 8 3

♥ Q J 10 6 4 2

♦ 7 3

♣ 4 2

♠ K J 7

♥ A 9 5

♦ J 10 9 2

♣ A K 10

West

North

East

South

2♥

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♥7

South's 2NT overcall shows a 1NT opening hand with ♥s stopped. South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♥7.

East plays the ♥10.

Winners: ♠=0 ♥=2 ♦=0 ♣=2 Total = 4

You will need to establish both ♠ and ♦ winners. If East holds both these Aces along with 6 ♥s to the Q J then you are going down. But of course East can't have that good a hand, he opened with a Weak-2. So West has one of the Aces.

If you knew which Ace East held you could make sure you attacked that suit first but unfortunately you have no way of knowing that. So instead you resort to a hold-up.

East continues with the ♥Q.

West follows with the ♥3.

You let East have the first ♥ and won the next ♥ in dummy.

Start on ♦s next, maybe because they are longer. Assume that West holds the ♦A and takes it on the third round of the suit.

West glares at you, (because he has no ♥ to lead), and plays the ♣Q which you take with your ♣A. Next you score your ♦ winners and play a ♠, taken by East with the ♠A.

East glares at you, (because you still have the ♥A), and plays another ♥.

You take your 3 tricks and let West have the last ♣.

If you did not hold up on the first trick, but established ♦s first you would not have made the contract.

If you did not hold up on the first trick, but established ♠s first you would have made the contract even though you played incorrectly.

If you held up on the first trick you made the contract no matter which Ace West held.

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 4 3
 ♥ K Q 10 9 5
 ♦ Q 4
 ♣ 10 5 2

♠ A Q 6

♥ 8 4 2

♦ 7 6 5 2

♣ K Q 3



♠ J 10 8 7

♥ 6

♦ K J 10 9

♣ J 9 8 4

♠ K 5 2

♥ A J 7 3

♦ A 8 3

♣ A 7 6

West	North	East	South
			1NT

Pass 3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♥K

continue, just what you want.

Sometimes it works, sometimes it doesn't.

I sure hope that when you play this hand West falls for your Bath Coup.

Because if he doesn't you're going to have to end-play him.

Do you see how that might happen?

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♥K, dummy plays the ♥2 and East the ♥6.

Winners: ♠=3 ♥=1 ♦=1 ♣=3 Total = 8

You just need one more winner and it could come from the ♦ suit if it happens to split 3-3. But you have another possibility. Suppose you let West hold the first trick and he decides to play another ♥? You would have two ♥ winners.

This isn't a true hold-up play although it does look like one. This play has the rather fancy name of Bath Coup, (named from Bath, England). Presumably West has led from ♥ K Q 10 9 5 and East has played his singleton ♥6. If West realizes that East has played his lowest card he will take that as a discouraging signal and will play a different suit. So you throw out your ♥7 rather than the ♥3. Now West may think that East is encouraging him to

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A K J 5
 ♥ J 10 9 8
 ♦ 9 6 4
 ♣ 10 3

♠ 9 6 2

♥ Q 5

♦ Q 10 5

♣ A Q 9 7 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 7 3

♥ K 6 4 3

♦ K 7 3 2

♣ 5 2

♠ Q 8 4

♥ A 7 2

♦ A J 8

♣ K J 8 6

West	North	East	South
			1NT

Pass 3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♥J

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♥J. You try dummy's ♥Q but East plays the ♥K.

Winners: ♠=0 ♥=1 ♦=1 ♣=5 Total = 7

Things do not look good. You have only one ♥ stopper, the ♠ suit is wide open, and you have to have the ♦ finesse to get the two extra winners you need.

First problem: Do you hold up the ♥A or not?

No, don't hold up. If you do they might take 4 ♠ tricks immediately, then go back to ♥s. Since your only hope of making this contract is the ♦ finesse you should grab the ♥A, play 5 rounds of ♣s then finesse for the ♦K.

Or not.

Remember: don't hold up when it gives the defenders a good opportunity to switch.

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 6 3
♥ K J 9 6 3
♦ 8 4 2
♣ Q 9

♠ Q 7 4

♥ 8 5

♦ K J 10 3

♣ 7 5 4 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 10 8 2

♥ Q 10 4

♦ 9 7

♣ A 10 8 3

♠ A K 5

♥ A 7 2

♦ A Q 6 5

♣ K J 6

West	North	East	South
			2NT

Pass 3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♥6

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♥6, dummy plays the ♥5 and East the ♥Q.

Winners: ♠=3 ♥=1 ♦=4 ♣=0 Total = 8

You need only one more winner.

East returns the ♥10.

West wins with the ♥J and continues with the ♥3; dummy discards a ♣ and East plays the ♥4.

Needing only one more winner, you held up on the first ♥ and on the continuation, taking your ♥A on the third round.

You need one trick from the ♣ suit, so you win 4 ♦ tricks, then the ♠A, ♠Q, putting you in dummy. Next you play a ♣ from dummy, and when East plays low you put on . . . which ♣?

You need one trick from the ♣ suit, so you win 4 ♦ tricks, then the ♠A, ♠Q, putting you in dummy. Next you play a ♣ from dummy, and when East plays low you put on . . . which ♣?

This is not a guess. If West has the ♣A he will get the lead and when he does he will set you with 2 more ♥ tricks. So you assume that East has the ♣A and play your ♣K.

This is a lesson about holding up, and if you had not held up twice in ♥s you would certainly have gone down.

But it's not enough to just be smart enough to hold up, you must also be able to figure out how to make the best plays later as well.